MODULE 2 · USING THE MEL

Lesson 03: Using the MEL for Dispatch

Lesson 3 of 4 · about 6 min

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Apply the MEL dispatch process as a crew.
- Combine several MEL items correctly.
- Recognise items that affect specific approvals and performance.



Tech log, MEL, (M), (O), brief.

The dispatch process

1. Read the **technical log**: open defects and deferred items.
2. Find each item in the MEL and read the **preamble and definitions** if in doubt.
3. Check the **number required**, the **category and expiry date**, and the remarks.
4. Confirm that the **(M) procedure** has been completed and the placard fitted.
5. Apply the **(O) procedure**: performance penalties, fuel, flight planning restrictions, in-flight actions.
6. Brief the crew on the effect of the item.

Several items together

The MEL items are written independently. When several items are inoperative, the commander must consider their **combined effect** — some combinations are not acceptable even if each item alone is. Check the MEL preamble guidance on multiple items.

Specific approvals and performance

- The MEL contains the dispatch requirements for systems that need a specific approval or capability: **RVSM, RNAV/PBN, LVO**, and others. An item can remove a capability (for example: no RVSM, no CAT II).
- Many items carry **performance penalties** — more critical on hot days and short runways.
- Some items restrict operation in icing conditions or at night.

COMMANDER'S DECISION

Dispatch under the MEL is allowed, not obligatory. The commander may refuse an aircraft if, in the actual conditions, the combination of items is unsafe.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Tech log → MEL item → category and expiry → (M) done and placard → (O) applied → brief.
- Consider the combined effect of several items.
- MEL items can remove RVSM, PBN or LVO capability and add performance penalties.

KNOWLEDGE CHECK

Two MEL items are each acceptable alone. What must the commander consider?

A. Nothing more

B. Their combined effect on safety in the actual conditions

C. Only the item with the longer interval

D. Only the newer item

Answer: B. The combined effect of multiple items must be considered.

Training material only. It does not replace the Aircraft Flight Manual, FCOM, QRH, MEL or the Domestic Airlines Operations Manual, which always take precedence.